

1.3. Cropping, Resizing And Rotating Images

Now that we have seen the various image formats and input devices, let's do some very basic photo-editing. This chapter is about the use of Adobe Photoshop as an editing tool, unless stated otherwise.

1.3.1. Cropping

Cropping is the process of removing portions of an image to create focus or strengthen the composition. In Photoshop, you can crop an image using the crop tool and the Crop command. You can also trim pixels using the Trim command. The crop tool provides the most options for cropping images.

To crop an image:

1. Select the crop tool.
2. Set the mode of the crop tool:
 - To crop the image without resampling (default), make sure that all the text boxes in the options bar are empty. You can click the **Clear** button to quickly clear all text boxes.
 - To resample the image during cropping, enter a height, width and/or resolution in the options bar. Resampling during cropping combines the function of the **Image > Image Size** command with that of the crop tool.
3. Define the cropping marquee by dragging over the part of the image you want to keep. The marquee doesn't have to be precise—you can adjust it later.

Note

In Photoshop, the Hide option is not available for images that contain only a background layer. If you want to crop a background by hiding, convert the background to a regular layer first. Specify whether you want to use a cropping shield to shade the area of the image that will be deleted or hidden. When Shield is selected, you can specify a colour and opacity for the cropping shield. When Shield is deselected, the area outside the cropping marquee is revealed.

Note

In Photoshop, you can't rotate the marquee for an image in the Bitmap mode.